TL-05: EMERGENCY EVACUATION BAG CHECKLIST

A practical planning and preparedness worksheet for assembling a 72-hour bug-out bag.

THE ABSOLUTE MAXIMUM WEIGHT RULE

An emergency bag is useless if you collapse from exhaustion trying to carry it. Your fully loaded bag must never weigh more than 20% of your actual body weight. If you weigh 150 lbs, your bag cannot exceed 30 lbs. If you weigh 200 lbs, your bag cannot exceed 40 lbs. Use a scale to verify this before you leave.

BAG CONFIGURATION PROFILE

■ Full Name of Person Carrying This Bag: _____

■ Actual Body Weight: _____ lbs | Maximum Bag Weight Target (Body Weight x 0.20): _____ lbs

■ Final Scale Weight of Fully Packed Bag: _____ lbs (Must be equal to or less than target)

■ Primary Emergency Evacuation Route / Destination: _____

HOW TO PACK FOR SPEED AND ACCURACY

• Pack heavy items (water, food, tools) in the center of the bag, close to your spine. This keeps you balanced.

• Keep critical emergency gear (first aid, flashlight, rain poncho) in outside pouches. Never dig to the bottom for a bandage.

• Put everything that can be ruined by water inside clear plastic zip-top freezer bags before stuffing it into the main pack.

MOBILIZATION VECTOR	CRITICAL GOAL	VERIFICATION STEP
STEP 1: HYDRATION	Secure 3 liters of drinkable water.	Fill water containers completely; inspect caps for active leaks.
STEP 2: NUTRITION	Pack 3 days of zero-cook food.	Verify calorie density; check that no item requires boiling water.
STEP 3: PLATFORM	Balance the weight distribution.	Put the loaded pack on; adjust straps until the weight sits on hips.

1. TIER 1 & TIER 2: IMMEDIATE LIFE SUPPORT

Load these items first. They handle the two fastest threats to life: severe bleeding and exposure to extreme weather. Keep these in easily accessible areas or outside pockets.

■ TIER 1: TRAUMA & BLEEDING CORNER (OUTSIDE POUCH FOR IMMEDIATE ACCESS)

[ ] 1 Commercial Tourniquet (CAT or SOFTT-W). Must be pre-staged and completely free of plastic wrapper.

[ ] 2 Pairs of disposable nitrile gloves (Size: Large or Extra Large so they fit anyone).

[ ] 2 Sterile trauma dressings (Israeli style or thick compression bandages).

[ ] 1 Pair of medical trauma shears. Used to cut away heavy clothing to find a wound quickly.

[ ] 1 Permanent marker. Used to write the exact time a tourniquet was applied directly onto the victim's forehead.

■ TIER 2: SHELTER, INSULATION, & CLIMATE SHIELDS

[ ] 2 Heavy-duty emergency space blankets. Use one on the ground and wrap the second around your body.

[ ] 1 Compact rain poncho. Must fit easily over your clothing and your packed bag.

[ ] 50 Feet of 550 paracord (sturdy nylon cord). Used to tie down a shelter or secure loose gear.

[ ] 3 Pairs of thick, synthetic or wool socks. Never pack cotton. Wet cotton freezes feet and causes severe blisters.

[ ] 1 Set of thermal base layers (top and bottom). Stored inside a sealed, waterproof plastic bag.

[ ] 1 Sturdy disposable lighter AND 1 box of waterproof matches. Kept inside a dry pocket.

ITEM SYSTEM	MINIMUM CAPABILITY SPECIFICATION	EMERGENCY INSTRUCTION / SUBSTITUTE
Water Container	1-liter single-wall stainless steel bottle.	Can be placed directly into hot coals to boil and purify water. Do not use insulated double-wall bottles.
Emergency Tarp	1 compact, water-resistant utility tarp.	Can be hung between trees using paracord to build an immediate roof against rain and wind.
Trauma Kit	Must contain bleeding control items only.	Keep this separate from daily medications, band-aids, or blister cream. Minutes matter for severe cuts.

2. TIER 3 & TIER 4: SUSTAINMENT & TOOLS

These items keep you moving, alert, and capable of handling physical obstacles. They go inside the main body compartments of your bag.

■ TIER 3: HYDRATION & RE-SUPPLY TOOLS

[ ] 1 Portable water filter straw (Sawyer Squeeze or LifeStraw). Rated to clean at least 1,000 gallons.

[ ] 10 Water purification tablets. Use only if water is clear of dirt but needs biological disinfection.

[ ] 1 Sturdy, wide-mouth plastic water container (1-liter capacity) to hold raw water before filtering.

■ TIER 4: CALORIC RESERVE (ZERO-COOK NO-PREP NUTRITION)

[ ] 3 Days of dense emergency ration bars. Total 2,400 calories per day minimum.

[ ] 6 High-protein meat sticks or meat jerky packs. Shelf-stable, ready to chew while walking.

[ ] 1 Manual can opener (P-38 style or simple hand tool). Keep this in your food pouch even if your cans have pull-tabs.

■ TIER 5: NAVIGATION, SIGNALING, & LIGHTING HARDWARE

[ ] 1 LED Headlamp with 1 complete set of replacement batteries. Keeps your hands free to carry gear.

[ ] 1 High-decibel safety whistle. Takes much less energy than shouting and carries twice as far.

[ ] Local physical paper maps of your town and county. Stored flat inside a clear plastic bag.

[ ] 1 Baseplate compass. Learn how to point the arrow toward your destination before you walk out the door.

[ ] 1 Sturdy multi-tool containing pliers, wire cutters, and a dedicated locking knife blade.

HARDWARE OVERVIEW	INTENDED APPLICATION	UNTRAINED WORKAROUND
LED Headlamp	Illumination for hands-free night movement.	Strap it to your head before it gets dark. Never use a phone light; it drains critical battery.
Water Filter Straw	Cleaning raw creek or ditch water.	Screw the filter onto a standard plastic bottle filled with creek water; squeeze water through the tip.
Physical Paper Map	Navigating roads when cell networks fail.	Identify major highway names and cardinal directions (North, South, East, West) before moving.

3. VERIFICATION, AUDIT, & LOGISTICS

FIELD PREPARATION RULES

- All fluid containers must be filled with fresh, clean drinking water before deployment.
- All batteries must be removed from flashlights/headlamps and stored in plastic cases so they do not drain or leak inside the bag.
- All personal paper copies (ID, insurance, contact sheets) must be placed flat inside a waterproof sleeve.
- Food items must be checked; all items have at least 12 months remaining before their expiration dates.
- The pack must be lifted, adjusted, and walked around the block for 15 minutes to check for pain points or shifts.

DOCUMENT REFRESH MATRIX

Inspect this bag completely every six months. Swap out water, check battery dates, and adjust clothing layers for the season.

LOG EVENT	LOG DATE	INSPECTOR	ACTIONS TAKEN / SUPPLIES COPIED
INITIAL BUILD	_____	_____	Bag loaded, weight balanced, profiles complete.
6-MONTH AUDIT	_____	_____	Water rotated, battery cells checked, food dates verified.
12-MONTH AUDIT	_____	_____	Cold/hot weather layers swapped, straps inspected for wear.

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FIELD SOURCES AND AUTHORITATIVE TECHNICAL REFERENCES
- **Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA) / Ready.gov - Short-Term Storage Supply Standards**
- **Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC) - Personal Emergency Logistics Frameworks**
- **National Fire Protection Association (NFPA) - Standard on Disaster/Emergency Management (NFPA 1600)**